

A The hardware configuration that your institution currently uses is just perfect. However, you will need to install a display card with TV-out capability. Doing so will help you connect the computer to the TV. Since your motherboard does not have an AGP slot, you need to find a PCI display card with a TV-out connector. You can either use an S-Video cable, or a composite cable (if the video card supports it) to connect the TV.

Q I have a Pentium III 733 MHz, a 20 GB hard drive and 128 MB of RAM. For the past one year, my motherboard's battery has been draining swiftly. I have to correct the system clock every time I reboot. A couple of months back, the computer refused to boot as well. If I change the battery, everything starts working normally again, including the clock. Does a computer refuse to boot if the battery is completely dead? If yes, why does this happen, and is there something wrong with my motherboard?

Tejendra Pathare

A It's unusual for a battery to drain so quickly. Your PC should boot, whether the battery is dead or not. Your motherboard seems to have a problem, contact your hardware vendor.

Q I am an IIT Mumbai student. We access the Internet via a LAN from our rooms. The problem is, my room has only one LAN socket, but we have two computers in the same room, and want to connect both. How can we allow both to connect to the network using the single LAN socket? What hardware and software do we need? Also, we may use Linux and/or Windows.

Vamsi Krishna

A The simplest solution is to buy a four-port hub, and connect that to your LAN socket. You can then connect up to four computers to that one LAN socket. A four-port hub costs around Rs 800.

Q One of my clients has a VIA chipset HIS Motherboard. The model is Pentium 4 2.66 GHz. The problem is that he wants